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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 2 | Trust — the Foundational Value in Relationship

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. TRUST (vishwas) is the assuredness that the other INTENDS my happiness — 'to be assured that each human being inherently wants oneself and the other to be happy and prosperous.' It is the foundation value of relationship because every other feeling — respect, affection, care — rests on it: if I doubt the other's intention, I cannot respect or care for them, and I live in fear and opposition instead of fearlessness.
2. Q2. In evaluating trust we must separate INTENTION from COMPETENCE. INTENTION (niyat) is what the other fundamentally wants — and the natural acceptance of every human being is to make oneself and the other happy, so intention is always right. COMPETENCE (yogyata) is the ABILITY to fulfil that intention — and competence varies: it depends on the person's present level of understanding, which may be incomplete. When I evaluate, I must evaluate the other's INTENTION (which is right, like mine) and not condemn them on the basis of their incomplete COMPETENCE.
3. Q3. The COMMON MISTAKE: I evaluate MYSELF on the basis of my INTENTION ('I am good, my intention is right') but I evaluate the OTHER on the basis of their COMPETENCE ('he could not do it properly, so he is bad'). This double standard makes me always right and the other always wrong — and it is the root of irritation, anger and the breaking of trust. The right approach is the mirror image: evaluate the other's intention (always right, naturally) and one's own competence (which needs improvement).
4. Q4. TRUST vs DEPENDABILITY: trust is the recognition that the other's INTENTION is right — unconditional, since intention is naturally acceptable in every human being. Dependability (bharosa on actions) depends on COMPETENCE — I may trust a person's intention fully yet not depend on them to drive my car if they cannot drive. So trust is on intention (always possible), dependability is on competence (conditional). Confusing the two, we withdraw TRUST when competence fails — which is unjust and breaks relationship.
5. Q5. The natural acceptance of EVERY human being is the SAME — to be happy and to make the other happy; hence at the level of intention, all human beings are alike and related. COMPETENCE, however, DIFFERS from person to person because it depends on the present state of understanding, education and sanskar. So a child, a colleague and I are identical in intention but different in competence. Recognising this removes blame: when the other errs, it is a gap of competence (to be filled by guidance/education), not of intention (to be punished by mistrust).
6. Q6. Applying the 8 trust-evaluation questions to a close relationship (my friend): (1) Do I want to make myself happy? Yes. (2) Do I want to make the other happy? Yes. (3) Does the other want to make himself happy? Yes. (4) Does the other want to make me happy? Yes — naturally acceptable. (5) Am I able to make myself always happy? Not always — intention yes, competence no. (6) Am I able to make the other always happy? Not always. (7) Is the other able to make himself always happy? Not always. (8) Is the other able to make me always happy? Not always. CONCLUSION: intention is right on both sides; only competence is lacking on both sides — so there is a ground for unconditional trust, and the remedy is mutual guidance, not mistrust.